

even when you're not in the mood. By doing so, you will quickly move to a higher level of life. Along the way, make sure you check your bank account, because, guaranteed, that will be growing quickly too.

At this point in some of my evening seminars I ask the audience, "How many of you are willing to practice acting in spite of fear and discomfort?" Usually everyone puts his or her hand up (probably because they're scared to death I'm going to "pick" on them). Then I say, "Talk is cheap! Let's see whether you mean it." I then pull out a wooden arrow with a steel-pointed tip and explain that as a practice for this discipline, you're going to break this arrow with your throat. I then demonstrate how the steel point goes into the soft part of your throat, while another person holds the other end of the arrow against their outstretched palm. The idea is to walk straight into the arrow and break it using only your throat before it pierces through your neck.

At this point most people are in shock! Sometimes I pick one volunteer to do this exercise, sometimes I hand out arrows to everyone. I've done audiences where over a thousand people are breaking arrows!

Can this feat be accomplished? Yes. Is it scary? You bet. Is it uncomfortable? Absolutely. But again, the idea is that fear and discomfort do not stop you. The idea is to practice, to train yourself to do whatever it takes, and to act in spite of anything that might be in your way.

Do most people break the arrow? Yes, everyone who walks into it with 100 percent commitment breaks it. However, those who walk into it slowly, halfheartedly, or not at all, don't.

After the arrow exercise I ask people, "How many of you found the arrow easier to break physically than what your mind made it up to be?" All agree it was actually a lot easier than they thought it would be. Why is this so? Here comes one of the most important lessons you will ever learn.

Your mind is the greatest soap-opera scriptwriter in history. It makes up incredible stories, usually based in dramas and disasters, of things that never happened and probably never will. Mark Twain said it best: "I've had thousands of problems in my life, most of which never actually happened."

One of the most important things you can ever understand is that *you are not your mind*. You are much bigger and greater than your mind alone. Your mind is a part of you just as your hand is a part of you.

Here's a thought-provoking question: What if you had a hand that was just like your mind? It was scattered all over the place, it was always